Whitney Kotlewski, PhD

VP of Product Experiences | Strategy & Portfolio Leadership | AI, Data & Spatial Platforms

+1 (909) 268-5698 | wkotlewski3@gmail.com | wkotlewski.github.io | linkedin.com/in/whitney-k-phd

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Product executive with 17+ years leading strategy, vision, and execution across AI, data, and spatial platforms. Directs cross-functional teams, guides organizations through change, and partners with executive leadership to set priorities and deliver business results across enterprise software and mission-critical operations.

CORE SKILLS

Product strategy | Portfolio management | Roadmap prioritization | Customer discovery | Go-to-market | Sales enablement | Opportunity sizing | Organizational leadership | Hiring & budgeting | AI/ML | Data platforms | Design systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Slingshot Aerospace | Apr 2024 - Present

Vice President of Product | Apr 2026 - Present

Senior Director of Product | 2025 - 2026; Head of Product Design & Research | 2024 - 2025

- Led delivery of Slingshot Portal's reusable platform in 2 months; grew users 3x within 4 months of launch. Own vision and roadmaps for space operations intelligence and autonomy, plus APIs, MCP, and enterprise capabilities.
- Established a biweekly release cadence, enabling consistent delivery and deeper measurement of adoption, usage, and customer feedback to validate product decisions and inform roadmap priorities.
- Report to the CTO; scaled the product organization ~6x across product management, strategy, design, research, customer experience, and space data in the U.S. and U.K.
- Partner with GTM and leadership on sales, demonstrations, and strategic opportunities during a tenure encompassing ~$124M in company capital raised and $96M+ in U.S. Space Force awards, including $27M for AI training and a $69.2M Phase III contract.
- Built Product Superbase, an AI-enabled framework connecting strategy, user research, decisions, and delivery evidence to team workflows; improved transparency, traceability, and roadmap alignment.
- Established shared product and marketing design systems with ~240 tokens and 1,200+ mission-operations components to support reuse across platform experiences.

Matterport | Apr 2021 - Oct 2023

Director, Product Design - Platform & Services

- Led design across eight platform experiences spanning web, marketplace, eCommerce, cloud, enterprise, and developer APIs and SDKs following a ~$2.9B public listing. Company revenue grew from ~$111M to ~$158M and subscribers nearly doubled (~1.9x) by FY2023.
- Scaled design 8x and helped expand the broader organization ~3x; led hiring, organizational planning, budgeting, and strategic planning.
- Integrated AI/ML into 3D digital twins; advanced research, accessibility, and design systems; partnered with Marketing on customer journeys, positioning, and launches.

Esri | Oct 2014 - Apr 2021

Head of UX Innovation & Special Programs | Dec 2019 - Apr 2021
Design Lead & Senior UX Architect | Oct 2014 - Dec 2019
Concurrent: Co-Founder & Director, Black Girls MAPP | Feb 2019 - May 2021

- Led enterprise product and UX innovation across analytics, drone mapping, mobile navigation, 2D/3D GIS, and developer APIs and SDKs, including applied machine learning, as company revenue grew from ~$1.1B to $1.3B+.
- Led a five-person design team and co-founded a 150+ person civic technology initiative delivering 24 maps, 24 data layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic products; recognized with the 2021 AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award.

ADVISORY, TEACHING & EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Sonara | Executive Design Advisor / Advisory Board Member | Jul 2022 - Oct 2023
Advised the CEO and CIO on experience strategy and operational improvements, helping grow subscription purchases ~80x. Acquired by BOLD in 2024.

Claremont Graduate University | Adjunct Professor | Aug 2024 - Present
Created Design for Good, the university's first-ever novel incubator program and course.

Pacific Life | Customer Experience Lead & Research Consultant | Feb - Oct 2014
IUPUI | UX Design Lead, Instructor & Researcher | Jul 2010 - Jul 2013
Various Companies | Media, Web & Print Designer | Apr 2009 - Jul 2013

EDUCATION & RESEARCH

PhD, Information Systems & Technology | Claremont Graduate University | 2024
AI and data visualization dissertation; patent pending.
MS, Informatics | Indiana University-Purdue University Indianapolis | 2013
MS, Human-Computer Interaction; BA | Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute | 2010